



ADVANCED PRESENTATIONS FOR CONSULTANTS

COURSE SUMMARY



EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Pyramid Principle

- The Pyramid Principle is a style of communication that starts with the conclusion, then proceeds logically through each supporting argument.
- Statements within a pyramid should be grouped and summarized. Each statement should summarize the idea of all statements below it.
- The Pyramid Principle is designed to make communication simple and natural by starting at the highest level idea and progressively guiding the audience into increasing levels of detail.
- The Pyramid Principle primarily relies on the concept of inductive reasoning, which is just a method for reasoning where you take separate pieces of information to form a conclusion.
- Unlike inductive reasoning, deductive reasoning uses ideas that connect to each other in order to reach a conclusion.
- The Pyramid Principle provides four major benefits: it saves time, it forces focus, it's adaptable, and it's easy to follow.

Storyboarding

- A storyboard is just a basic outline of your final presentation that you create before developing any slides.
- A storyboard is useful because it can help in making sure your presentation sticks to the structure of the Pyramid Principle.
- Using a storyboard helps your audience clearly understand your main message, how you've reached your conclusions, and what information in your deck is most important.
- An easy way to develop a storyboard is to first think about how you want to structure your argument, then give each of the main points of that argument its own slide to be developed more fully later.
- Creating a storyboard can help in structuring your overall project so that everyone knows how each slide will fit into the final presentation.
- Simplify the storyboarding process by writing it out on paper or Excel first, keeping it high level, and utilizing PowerPoint features such as Outline Mode and Slider Sorter.

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Slide Structure

- In order to provide good slide structure, it's important to make sure the Pyramid Principle is applied to your slide.
- Establishing good slide structure can be done by making sure the overall message of the slide is reflected in the slide title.
- It's also important to guide the reader's attention to what's most important by grouping and summarizing the data on your slide.
- Remove anything on the slide that doesn't contribute to the main message.
- Your slide might not always reflect the Pyramid Principle visually, but following the main concepts of top-down communication can help in making sure your message is well structured and easy to understand.

INSIGHTFUL SLIDE DESIGN

Highlight Your Structure

- Highlighting your structure will help the audience understand the information on your slide quickly and easily.
- One way to highlight your structure is by positioning the text correctly, with the title at the top of the page and the subtitles either just below the title or off to the left.
- Another way to highlight the structure is by adjusting the size, color, or boldness of important text on your slide.
- Adding additional objects to the slide such as lines, shapes, or bullets can help in highlighting the structure of a slide. This method is especially useful for highlighting subtitles.

Visualize Your Message

- Visuals can really help enhance your slides and improve overall readability and clarity.
- The first way to visualize your message is to add a chart, which allows you to show quantitative data in a way that is easy to understand and conveys credibility.
- Next is to add a qualitative visual, which can include frameworks, flow charts, logic trees, and matrices, among other things. These types of visuals are especially helpful when you're trying to replace text.
- Another way is to add icons, which can make the text of your slides just a little bit easier to understand quickly, and can also improve the overall look of a slide.
- You can also add photos, which can be used to help understand text, show something to the audience they might not be able to visualize, or to add an aesthetic look to your title and transition slides.
- Then lastly, you can utilize other types of graphics such as logos, drawings, diagrams, and maps. When used correctly these can also help the audience comprehend the content on your slides with less effort.
- As you use these tools to visualize your message, it's important to always consider the purpose of your visual, and whether or not it adds or takes away from the clarity of your presentation.

INSIGHTFUL SLIDE DESIGN

Focus the Audience's Attention

- Focusing the audience's attention on the important elements of a slide can help them process the information more quickly.
- Drawing attention to the key elements of your charts, particularly through the use of color, circles, arrows, and callouts, can help improve slide comprehension.
- Another way to improve comprehension is by highlighting parts of the text on your slide, which you can do either by adjusting the text itself, or by adding visuals to the text such as callouts, circles, arrows, or boxes.
- It's important to keep the overall structure of your slide in focus so that the audience can still quickly and easily understand the overall message of your slide.

Finish with Formatting

- Not only does a properly formatted slide look better, but it conveys professionalism and limits distractions. Whereas a poorly formatted slide can make it difficult for the audience to focus on your message.
- The first part of proper formatting involves aligning and distributing the content on your slide. Align various objects together to show they are related and make sure there is a margin around the edges of your slide.
- It's important to consider the text formatting of your slide including spelling, grammar, punctuation, spacing, indentation, structure, and tone.
- Keep the formatting of your slides consistent throughout the deck including the font, color, and overall design.
- Where possible, use frameworks to help provide a visual structure and consistency to portions of your deck.



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